

Numerical sampling and constraint construction for a Chebyshev-Fourier DNS of turbulent channel flow

Prepared for the MKM channel-flow data-estimation workflow

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Abstract

This note gives a self-contained description of the numerical setup used to sample data from the MKM channel-flow demonstration in `shenfun`, and of the postprocessing procedure used to construct the target quantities for a horizontally periodic, wall-normal inhomogeneous data set. The discussion is organized at the level needed to reproduce the stored objects in the HDF5 target file. We first define the channel-flow geometry, the Chebyshev-Fourier mesh, the two-stage spin-up and sampling procedure, and the component ordering used by the stored data. We then derive, step by step, the sampled mean profile, Reynolds-stress profile, horizontal Fourier coefficients, equal-time modal covariance, positive-lag modal covariance, and plane-averaged temporal auto-covariance and auto-spectrum diagnostics. The production two-stage run on the current $(N_x, N_y, N_z) = (64, 32, 64)$ mesh is then summarized, including the accepted sampling window, block-convergence checks, instantaneous and mean velocity contours, mean velocity profile, Reynolds-stress tensor profile, temporal diagnostics, and constraint audit. Finally, we derive the modewise incompressibility and no-slip constraint matrix on the solver-native Chebyshev-Gauss quadrature grid, including the barycentric spectral derivative, the endpoint interpolation boundary operator, and the singular-value compression used to obtain the saved row-orthonormal constraint $\hat{G}(\kappa, \lambda)$.

Keywords: channel flow; direct numerical simulation; Chebyshev-Fourier method; modal covariance; incompressibility constraint; barycentric interpolation.

1 Purpose and scope

The objective of the workflow described here is to collect and postprocess a direct numerical simulation (DNS) of plane channel flow into a target data layout suitable for horizontally periodic, wall-normal inhomogeneous modeling. The DNS is run using the MKM channel-flow demonstration provided by `shenfun`. The postprocessed data are stored in horizontal Fourier space and retain the wall-normal dependence explicitly. For each horizontal mode, the stored quantities are compatible with a discrete incompressibility and no-slip constraint matrix.

This note focuses on the numerical method and the exact objects generated by the scripts in

`scripts/mkm_dns_target.`

The current production data set is generated by a two-stage run. A first stage develops the flow from the MKM demonstration initialization and writes no target snapshots. A second stage restarts from the accepted checkpoint and writes the velocity snapshots used for statistics and covariance estimation. The short four-snapshot run used earlier to validate the mechanics of this workflow is superseded here by the production run described in Section 5.

2 Physical and numerical setup

2.1 Channel geometry and variables

Let $x \in [0, L_x)$ denote the streamwise coordinate, let $y \in [0, L_y)$ denote the spanwise coordinate, and let $z \in [-1, 1]$ denote the wall-normal coordinate. The considered channel has

$$L_x = 2\pi, \quad L_y = \pi.$$

The velocity is written in the target component order

$$\mathbf{u} = (u_x, u_y, u_z)^T,$$

where u_x is streamwise velocity, u_y is spanwise velocity, and u_z is wall-normal velocity. In these variables the incompressibility constraint is

$$\partial_x u_x + \partial_y u_y + \partial_z u_z = 0. \quad (1)$$

The no-slip condition at both walls is

$$\mathbf{u}(x, y, -1, t) = \mathbf{0}, \quad \mathbf{u}(x, y, 1, t) = \mathbf{0}. \quad (2)$$

The solver advances the incompressible Navier-Stokes equations in a constant-flux channel configuration at friction Reynolds number

$$Re_\tau = 180.$$

In nondimensional form, a representative statement of the equation being advanced is

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0, \quad (3)$$

$$\partial_t \mathbf{u} + \mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla \mathbf{u} = -\nabla p + \frac{1}{Re_\tau} \Delta \mathbf{u} + f_x(t) \mathbf{e}_x, \quad (4)$$

with periodicity in x and y and no-slip walls in z . The MKM implementation uses the Kim-Moin-Moser channel-flow formulation in which the wall-normal velocity and wall-normal vorticity are advanced spectrally, while the remaining velocity components are reconstructed from incompressibility and the zero-horizontal-wavenumber momentum equations. This note does not require the internal solver variables; the sampled and constrained objects are written in the physical velocity component order (u_x, u_y, u_z) .

2.2 Nondimensionalization used in the figures

The natural scales for the present channel-flow data are the channel half-height h and the friction velocity u_τ . In the MKM configuration used here,

$$h = \frac{1 - (-1)}{2} = 1, \quad u_\tau = 1, \quad \nu = \frac{u_\tau h}{Re_\tau} = \frac{1}{180}.$$

All figures below therefore report the nondimensional coordinates and statistics

$$x^* = \frac{x}{h}, \quad y^* = \frac{y}{h}, \quad z^* = \frac{z}{h}, \quad t^* = \frac{tu_\tau}{h}, \quad (5)$$

and

$$u_i^* = \frac{u_i}{u_\tau}, \quad R_{\alpha\beta}^* = \frac{R_{\alpha\beta}}{u_\tau^2}. \quad (6)$$

Since $h = u_\tau = 1$ in this run, these scalings leave the numerical values unchanged, but they identify the axes and colorbar values as friction-scaled channel-flow quantities. The constant-flux diagnostic gives the reference bulk velocity

$$\frac{U_b}{u_\tau} = \frac{Q}{2hL_xL_yu_\tau} \approx \frac{618.9703}{4\pi^2} = 15.6788, \quad (7)$$

which is useful as a run check but is not used as the primary plotting scale; the velocity and Reynolds-stress plots use the standard friction scaling in Eqs. (5)–(6).

2.3 Chebyshev-Fourier grid

The current mesh is

$$(N_x, N_y, N_z) = (64, 32, 64),$$

where N_x is the number of streamwise points, N_y is the number of spanwise points, and N_z is the number of wall-normal quadrature points.

The default saved wall-normal mesh is the solver-native Chebyshev-Gauss quadrature mesh. For a general interval $[a, b]$, the nodes are

$$z_m = \frac{a+b}{2} + \frac{b-a}{2} \cos\left(\frac{(2m+1)\pi}{2N_z}\right), \quad m = 0, \dots, N_z - 1. \quad (8)$$

For the present channel $a = -1$ and $b = 1$. The endpoints $z = -1$ and $z = 1$ are not members of the Chebyshev-Gauss grid; this point matters for the construction of the boundary rows in Section 4.

The horizontal grids are equispaced:

$$x_j = j \frac{L_x}{N_x}, \quad j = 0, \dots, N_x - 1, \quad (9)$$

and

$$y_\ell = \ell \frac{L_y}{N_y}, \quad \ell = 0, \dots, N_y - 1. \quad (10)$$

The corresponding discrete Fourier wavenumbers are those returned by `numpy.fft.fftfreq`:

$$\kappa_p = 2\pi \text{fftfreq}(N_x, L_x/N_x)_p, \quad p = 0, \dots, N_x - 1, \quad (11)$$

$$\lambda_q = 2\pi \text{fftfreq}(N_y, L_y/N_y)_q, \quad q = 0, \dots, N_y - 1. \quad (12)$$

2.4 Time integration and staged sampling

The production run used the following solver settings:

$$\begin{aligned} Re_\tau &= 180, & \Delta t &= 5 \times 10^{-4}, & \text{conv} &= 0, \\ \text{family} &= \mathbf{C}, & \text{padding_factor} &= (1.5, 1.5, 1.5), & \text{timestepper} &= \text{IMEXRK222}. \end{aligned}$$

The data collection is explicitly split into two stages.

First, a spin-up stage starts from the MKM demonstration initialization. It writes no velocity snapshots for the target data set. Its only persistent state is a checkpoint forced at the final time. In the production run,

$$t_{\text{spin}} u_\tau / h = 20, \quad n_{\text{spin}} = 40000.$$

Second, a sampling stage restarts from this checkpoint and writes velocity snapshots at a fixed step cadence. Snapshots were written every 200 time steps, so that

$$\Delta t_{\text{sample}} u_\tau / h = 200 \Delta t u_\tau / h = 0.1.$$

The sampling stage was appended in four segments:

$$[20, 60], \quad [60, 100], \quad [100, 140], \quad [140, 180].$$

The first segment created the sampled velocity file, and the later segments used append mode. The raw sampled velocity file therefore covers

$$tu_\tau / h = 20.1, 20.2, \dots, 180.0,$$

with 1600 snapshots. No spin-up snapshots are present in that sampled velocity file. After convergence checks, the accepted target window was chosen as

$$\mathcal{T}_{\text{acc}} = \{60.0, 60.1, \dots, 180.0\} \quad \text{in } tu_\tau / h, \quad N_s = 1201. \quad (13)$$

Only these accepted snapshots enter the final mean, Reynolds-stress, modal coefficient, and covariance estimates.

3 Sampled velocity fields and target statistics

3.1 Component ordering

The MKM HDF5 output groups use the solver component labels

$$\mathbf{u}0 = u_z, \quad \mathbf{u}1 = u_x, \quad \mathbf{u}2 = u_y.$$

The postprocessor reorders these into the target component order

$$(u_x, u_y, u_z).$$

Let $\alpha, \beta \in \{x, y, z\}$ denote target component indices. For the n -th selected snapshot, define the sampled velocity values

$$u_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n), \quad n = 0, \dots, N_s - 1,$$

where N_s is the number of selected snapshots. Unless otherwise stated, the time origin in the estimators is reset to the first retained snapshot, so

$$t_n = n\Delta t_s.$$

The accepted production target uses $N_s = 1201$.

3.2 Mean profile

Because the channel is statistically homogeneous in x and y , the mean profile is a function only of the wall-normal coordinate. The estimator used in the target file is the average over selected snapshots and both horizontal directions:

$$\bar{u}_\alpha(z_m) = \frac{1}{N_s N_x N_y} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \sum_{j=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{N_y-1} u_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n). \quad (14)$$

This is the dataset `mean_profile`, stored with shape

$$(N_z, 3).$$

3.3 Fluctuation field

The fluctuation field is formed by subtracting the estimated mean profile from each selected snapshot:

$$u'_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) = u_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) - \bar{u}_\alpha(z_m). \quad (15)$$

This definition ensures that the horizontal and snapshot average of u'_α is zero for each wall-normal level when the same selected snapshots are used in Eqs. (14) and (15).

3.4 Reynolds-stress profile

The stored Reynolds-stress profile is the second moment of the fluctuation field at each wall-normal level:

$$R_{\alpha\beta}(z_m) = \frac{1}{N_s N_x N_y} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \sum_{j=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{N_y-1} u'_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) u'_\beta(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n). \quad (16)$$

The stored dataset is `reynolds_stress_profile`, with shape

$$(N_z, 3, 3).$$

3.5 Horizontal Fourier coefficients

For each snapshot and wall-normal level, the horizontal Fourier coefficient of the fluctuation field is defined by the normalized two-dimensional discrete Fourier transform

$$\hat{u}_\alpha(z_m; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) = \frac{1}{N_x N_y} \sum_{j=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{N_y-1} u'_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) \exp[-i(\kappa_p x_j + \lambda_q y_\ell)]. \quad (17)$$

This is the normalization used by

$$\text{np.fft.fft2}(\text{u_fluct}, \text{axes}=(\text{streamwise}, \text{spanwise})) / (\text{Nx} * \text{Ny}).$$

For a fixed horizontal mode (κ_p, λ_q) , the postprocessor stacks the three components level by level into the modal vector

$$\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) = \begin{bmatrix} \hat{u}_x(z_0; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_0; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_0; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_x(z_1; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_1; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_1; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \vdots \\ \hat{u}_x(z_{N_z-1}; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_{N_z-1}; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_{N_z-1}; \kappa_p, \lambda_q, t_n) \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^{3N_z}. \quad (18)$$

The dataset `modal/u_hat` stores these modal vectors with shape

$$(N_s, N_x, N_y, 3N_z).$$

For the accepted production target this is

$$(1201, 64, 32, 192).$$

3.6 Equal-time modal covariance

The equal-time covariance matrix for each horizontal mode is estimated from the selected snapshots by

$$B_{pq}^{(0)} = \frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)^*, \quad (19)$$

where $(\cdot)^*$ denotes conjugate transpose. Equation (19) is Hermitian and positive semidefinite in exact arithmetic. For numerical robustness, the stored matrix is symmetrized as

$$B_{pq, \text{stored}}^{(0)} = \frac{1}{2} \left(B_{pq}^{(0)} + \left(B_{pq}^{(0)} \right)^* \right). \quad (20)$$

The dataset `modal/B0_DNS` has shape

$$(N_x, N_y, 3N_z, 3N_z).$$

For the accepted production target this is

$$(64, 32, 192, 192).$$

3.7 Positive-lag modal covariance

For an integer lag $s \geq 0$, the positive-lag covariance uses the unbiased estimator

$$B_{pq}^{(s)} = \frac{1}{N_s - s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s - s - 1} \hat{q}_{pq}(t_{n+s}) \hat{q}_{pq}(t_n)^*, \quad 0 \leq s < N_s. \quad (21)$$

For $s = 0$, Eq. (21) equals Eq. (19). Therefore the stored `lag_0` provides an independent check against `BO_DNS`, up to the explicit Hermitian symmetrization in Eq. (20). The accepted production target saved `lag_0` and `lag_1`.

4 Derivation of the constraint matrix

This section derives the matrix $\tilde{G}(\kappa, \lambda)$ saved by the constraint builder. The construction starts from the continuous divergence and no-slip constraints, discretizes them on the same vertical grid and component ordering used by the target file, and then compresses the possibly redundant constraint rows by singular-value decomposition.

4.1 Fourier-mode form of incompressibility

Start from the continuous incompressibility equation

$$\partial_x u_x + \partial_y u_y + \partial_z u_z = 0.$$

For one horizontal Fourier mode (κ, λ) , write

$$u_\alpha(x, y, z) = \hat{u}_\alpha(z; \kappa, \lambda) \exp[i(\kappa x + \lambda y)]. \quad (22)$$

Substituting Eq. (22) into Eq. (1) gives

$$\partial_x u_x = i\kappa \hat{u}_x(z; \kappa, \lambda) \exp[i(\kappa x + \lambda y)],$$

$$\partial_y u_y = i\lambda \hat{u}_y(z; \kappa, \lambda) \exp[i(\kappa x + \lambda y)],$$

and

$$\partial_z u_z = \frac{d\hat{u}_z}{dz}(z; \kappa, \lambda) \exp[i(\kappa x + \lambda y)].$$

The exponential factor is nonzero for all x, y , so it can be divided out. The divergence-free condition for the mode is therefore

$$i\kappa \hat{u}_x(z; \kappa, \lambda) + i\lambda \hat{u}_y(z; \kappa, \lambda) + \frac{d\hat{u}_z}{dz}(z; \kappa, \lambda) = 0. \quad (23)$$

4.2 Fourier-mode form of no-slip boundary conditions

The no-slip condition is

$$u_x(x, y, \pm 1) = u_y(x, y, \pm 1) = u_z(x, y, \pm 1) = 0.$$

Using the single-mode representation in Eq. (22), for example at $z = 1$,

$$u_\alpha(x, y, 1) = \hat{u}_\alpha(1; \kappa, \lambda) \exp[i(\kappa x + \lambda y)].$$

Again the exponential factor is nonzero. Hence the boundary condition is equivalent mode by mode to

$$\hat{u}_\alpha(-1; \kappa, \lambda) = 0, \quad \hat{u}_\alpha(1; \kappa, \lambda) = 0, \quad \alpha \in \{x, y, z\}. \quad (24)$$

4.3 Nodal unknown vector and extraction matrices

For a fixed horizontal mode, define the nodal vectors

$$\hat{\mathbf{u}}_x = [\hat{u}_x(z_0) \quad \cdots \quad \hat{u}_x(z_{N_z-1})]^T,$$

and analogously $\hat{\mathbf{u}}_y, \hat{\mathbf{u}}_z$. The target modal vector stacks these values level by level:

$$\hat{\mathbf{q}} = \begin{bmatrix} \hat{u}_x(z_0) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_0) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_0) \\ \hat{u}_x(z_1) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_1) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_1) \\ \vdots \\ \hat{u}_x(z_{N_z-1}) \\ \hat{u}_y(z_{N_z-1}) \\ \hat{u}_z(z_{N_z-1}) \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^{3N_z}. \quad (25)$$

Define three extraction matrices

$$E_x, E_y, E_z \in \mathbb{R}^{N_z \times 3N_z}$$

by their nonzero entries

$$(E_x)_{m,3m} = 1, \quad (E_y)_{m,3m+1} = 1, \quad (E_z)_{m,3m+2} = 1, \quad m = 0, \dots, N_z - 1, \quad (26)$$

where zero-based indexing is used in Eq. (26), as in the implementation. Multiplying Eq. (25) by these matrices selects the component nodal vectors:

$$E_x \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \hat{\mathbf{u}}_x, \quad E_y \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \hat{\mathbf{u}}_y, \quad E_z \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \hat{\mathbf{u}}_z. \quad (27)$$

These extraction matrices are pure bookkeeping operators. They do not depend on the grid, the derivative approximation, or the wavenumber.

4.4 Barycentric spectral derivative on Chebyshev-Gauss nodes

Let $z_0, \dots, z_{N_z-1}$ be the Chebyshev-Gauss nodes in Eq. (8). The Lagrange cardinal polynomial associated with node z_j is denoted by $\ell_j(z)$, so that

$$\ell_j(z_i) = \delta_{ij}.$$

Any nodal polynomial interpolant of a scalar function f is

$$\mathcal{I}_{N_z} f(z) = \sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} f(z_j) \ell_j(z). \quad (28)$$

Differentiating Eq. (28) and evaluating at z_i gives

$$\left. \frac{d}{dz} \mathcal{I}_{N_z} f(z) \right|_{z=z_i} = \sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} f(z_j) \ell'_j(z_i). \quad (29)$$

Therefore the nodal derivative matrix is

$$(D_z)_{ij} = \ell'_j(z_i).$$

The implementation computes these entries using barycentric weights

$$\omega_j = \left(\prod_{\substack{\ell=0 \\ \ell \neq j}}^{N_z-1} (z_j - z_\ell) \right)^{-1}. \quad (30)$$

For $i \neq j$, the standard barycentric differentiation formula gives

$$(D_z)_{ij} = \frac{\omega_j}{\omega_i(z_i - z_j)}. \quad (31)$$

The diagonal entry is determined by differentiating the identity

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} \ell_j(z) = 1.$$

Taking a derivative and evaluating at z_i yields

$$\sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} \ell'_j(z_i) = 0.$$

Since $(D_z)_{ij} = \ell'_j(z_i)$, the diagonal entry must satisfy

$$(D_z)_{ii} + \sum_{\substack{j=0 \\ j \neq i}}^{N_z-1} (D_z)_{ij} = 0.$$

Thus

$$(D_z)_{ii} = - \sum_{\substack{j=0 \\ j \neq i}}^{N_z-1} (D_z)_{ij}. \quad (32)$$

Equations (31) and (32) define the saved `operators/D_wall` matrix for the solver-native Chebyshev-quadrature constraint.

4.5 Endpoint interpolation for no-slip rows

Because the Chebyshev-Gauss nodes exclude the walls, no-slip boundary values cannot be selected directly from the stored nodal vector. They must be interpolated from the quadrature nodes to $z = -1$ and $z = 1$.

Using the barycentric form of the interpolant in Eq. (28), for a point ξ that is not one of the nodes,

$$\mathcal{I}_{N_z} f(\xi) = \frac{\sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} \frac{\omega_j}{\xi - z_j} f(z_j)}{\sum_{j=0}^{N_z-1} \frac{\omega_j}{\xi - z_j}}. \quad (33)$$

Equation (33) is linear in the nodal values $f(z_j)$. Therefore the interpolation row $b(\xi) \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times N_z}$ has entries

$$b_j(\xi) = \frac{\frac{\omega_j}{\xi - z_j}}{\sum_{\ell=0}^{N_z-1} \frac{\omega_\ell}{\xi - z_\ell}}, \quad j = 0, \dots, N_z - 1. \quad (34)$$

The two-row boundary interpolation matrix is then

$$B_{\partial} = \begin{bmatrix} b(-1) \\ b(1) \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times N_z}. \quad (35)$$

For any nodal component vector $\hat{\mathbf{u}}_{\alpha}$,

$$B_{\partial} \hat{\mathbf{u}}_{\alpha} = \begin{bmatrix} \hat{u}_{\alpha}(-1) \\ \hat{u}_{\alpha}(1) \end{bmatrix}$$

in the polynomial-interpolation sense.

4.6 Discrete divergence rows

Evaluate the modal divergence equation (23) at all N_z Chebyshev-Gauss nodes. The first term is the streamwise derivative, which is multiplication by $i\kappa$ in Fourier space:

$$i\kappa \begin{bmatrix} \hat{u}_x(z_0) \\ \vdots \\ \hat{u}_x(z_{N_z-1}) \end{bmatrix} = i\kappa E_x \hat{\mathbf{q}}.$$

Similarly, the spanwise derivative contributes

$$i\lambda E_y \hat{\mathbf{q}}.$$

The wall-normal derivative is approximated by the spectral differentiation matrix acting on the wall-normal velocity component:

$$D_z E_z \hat{\mathbf{q}}.$$

Adding the three contributions gives

$$(i\kappa E_x + i\lambda E_y + D_z E_z) \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}. \quad (36)$$

Therefore the discrete divergence block is

$$G_{\text{div}}(\kappa, \lambda) = i\kappa E_x + i\lambda E_y + D_z E_z \in \mathbb{C}^{N_z \times 3N_z}. \quad (37)$$

4.7 Discrete boundary rows

The no-slip conditions in Eq. (24) require the two endpoint values of each component to vanish. For the streamwise component,

$$B_{\partial} E_x \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0} \in \mathbb{C}^2.$$

For the spanwise component,

$$B_{\partial} E_y \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0} \in \mathbb{C}^2.$$

For the wall-normal component,

$$B_{\partial} E_z \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0} \in \mathbb{C}^2.$$

Stacking these three two-row systems gives

$$G_{\partial} \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}, \quad G_{\partial} = \begin{bmatrix} B_{\partial} E_x \\ B_{\partial} E_y \\ B_{\partial} E_z \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^{6 \times 3N_z}. \quad (38)$$

4.8 Raw constraint matrix

The divergence constraint and boundary constraint must both hold. Combining Eqs. (37) and (38) gives the raw constraint matrix

$$G_{\text{raw}}(\kappa, \lambda) = \begin{bmatrix} G_{\text{div}}(\kappa, \lambda) \\ G_{\partial} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} i\kappa E_x + i\lambda E_y + D_z E_z \\ B_{\partial} E_x \\ B_{\partial} E_y \\ B_{\partial} E_z \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^{(N_z+6) \times 3N_z}. \quad (39)$$

Thus a modal velocity vector is discretely admissible if and only if

$$G_{\text{raw}}(\kappa, \lambda) \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}. \quad (40)$$

For $N_z = 64$, the raw constraint matrix has 70 rows and 192 columns. The SVD rank audit for the validation setup gives

$$\text{rank } G_{\text{raw}}(0, 0) = 68,$$

and

$$\text{rank } G_{\text{raw}}(\kappa, \lambda) = 70 \quad \text{for the remaining 2047 horizontal modes.}$$

4.9 SVD compression and the saved $\tilde{G}$

Some rows of G_{raw} may be linearly dependent, especially at the zero-horizontal-wavenumber mode. Moreover, later algorithms often benefit from a constraint matrix with orthonormal rows. The saved compressed matrix $\tilde{G}$ is constructed from the singular-value decomposition of G_{raw} .

Let

$$G_{\text{raw}} = U \Sigma V^* \quad (41)$$

be a full singular-value decomposition. Let the numerical rank be r , as determined by the relative tolerance

$$\sigma_j > 10^{-12} \sigma_0.$$

Partition the right singular vectors as

$$V = [V_r \quad V_0],$$

where $V_r \in \mathbb{C}^{3N_z \times r}$ corresponds to the retained singular values and $V_0 \in \mathbb{C}^{3N_z \times (3N_z - r)}$ spans the numerical nullspace. The rank- r part of Eq. (41) is

$$G_{\text{raw}} = U_r \Sigma_r V_r^*. \quad (42)$$

Here U_r has orthonormal columns and Σ_r is diagonal with strictly positive retained singular values. Therefore $U_r \Sigma_r$ has full column rank. For any vector $\hat{\mathbf{q}}$,

$$G_{\text{raw}} \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0} \iff U_r \Sigma_r V_r^* \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}.$$

Because $U_r \Sigma_r$ has full column rank, the only way the product above can vanish is

$$V_r^* \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}.$$

Conversely, if $V_r^* \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}$, then $G_{\text{raw}} \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}$. Thus

$$G_{\text{raw}} \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0} \iff V_r^* \hat{\mathbf{q}} = \mathbf{0}. \quad (43)$$

The saved row-orthonormal constraint matrix is therefore

$$\tilde{G}(\kappa, \lambda) = V_r^* \in \mathbb{C}^{r \times 3N_z}. \quad (44)$$

Since V is unitary, the rows of V_r^* are orthonormal:

$$\tilde{G}\tilde{G}^* = V_r^* V_r = I_r. \quad (45)$$

The nullspace matrix saved for representative modes is

$$N_{\text{mat}} = V_0. \quad (46)$$

Every vector of the form

$$\hat{\mathbf{q}} = N_{\text{mat}} \mathbf{a}$$

satisfies the constraint, because

$$\tilde{G}\hat{\mathbf{q}} = V_r^* V_0 \mathbf{a} = \mathbf{0}.$$

This also explains the stored nullity

$$\text{nullity} = 3N_z - r.$$

4.10 Uniform finite-difference alternative

The default for the present DNS target is the Chebyshev-quadrature spectral constraint derived above. The scripts also support a uniform-grid finite difference option for intentionally uniform saved data. In that case, the component extraction matrices E_x, E_y, E_z , the wavenumbers (κ, λ) , and the algebraic forms (37)–(39) do not change. Only the wall-normal grid, the derivative matrix, and the boundary matrix change.

For a uniform grid,

$$z_m = -1 + m \frac{2}{N_z - 1}, \quad m = 0, \dots, N_z - 1.$$

The boundary matrix is a selector:

$$B_{\partial} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The finite-difference derivative matrix is constructed row by row from local polynomial exactness. If row i uses stencil nodes $\{z_{j_0}, \dots, z_{j_{w-1}}\}$, then the weights c_s for the first derivative at z_i satisfy

$$\sum_{s=0}^{w-1} c_s (z_{j_s} - z_i)^p = \begin{cases} 1, & p = 1, \\ 0, & p = 0, 2, \dots, w-1. \end{cases} \quad (47)$$

Equation (47) is exactly the linear system solved by the finite-difference helper. For the earlier comparison, $w = 7$. This option is not the default for the present Chebyshev-quadrature DNS target.

5 Production two-stage results

The production output directory on the Linux server is

`/media/jay/data/shenfun_dns_runs/production_mkm.64_64_32_20260702.`

The final accepted target file is

`MKM_production.64_64_32_target_t60_t180.h5.`

The raw velocity file `MKM_production.64_64_32_U.h5` contains the full appended sampling record, while the target file contains only the accepted $60 \leq tu_{\tau}/h \leq 180$ subset.

Table 1: Field-statistical block-convergence checks for candidate sampling windows. The tolerance is 0.05 for both the mean profile and the Reynolds-stress profile.

Window	Snapshots	tu_τ/h range	Mean rel.	Reynolds rel.	Accepted
full record	1600	20.1–180	8.34×10^{-3}	5.36×10^{-2}	no
trimmed	1401	40–180	8.16×10^{-3}	5.09×10^{-2}	no
retained	1201	60–180	5.05×10^{-3}	4.17×10^{-2}	yes

5.1 Run summary and sampling-window selection

The production run used 16 MPI ranks. A 64-rank attempt was rejected by the current $(N_x, N_y, N_z) = (64, 32, 64)$ mesh because the Fourier decomposition required by the MPI transform was incompatible with the 32-point distributed direction. The 16-rank run completed the spin-up and four appended sampling segments cleanly:

$$tu_\tau/h = 0 \rightarrow 20, \quad 20 \rightarrow 60, \quad 60 \rightarrow 100, \quad 100 \rightarrow 140, \quad 140 \rightarrow 180.$$

The final DNS state was

$$t_{\text{final}}u_\tau/h \simeq 180, \quad n_{\text{final}} = 360000.$$

Table 1 reports the block-convergence decision used to select the accepted samples. The full sampled interval and the $40 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ interval were close to, but did not satisfy, the 5 percent Reynolds-stress block criterion. The final target therefore uses the $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ window.

Figure 1 shows the scalar sampling-stage diagnostics as relative deviations from their sampling means. The dashed line marks the accepted start time $tu_\tau/h = 60$. The bulk flux is steady to about 10^{-7} relative variation on this scale. The coarser scalar block parser still flags the spanwise kinetic-energy component over $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$: its first-to-last 12-block relative change is 7.23×10^{-2} . This caveat is retained in the handoff. The final data set is accepted by the field mean/Reynolds-stress convergence criterion in Table 1.

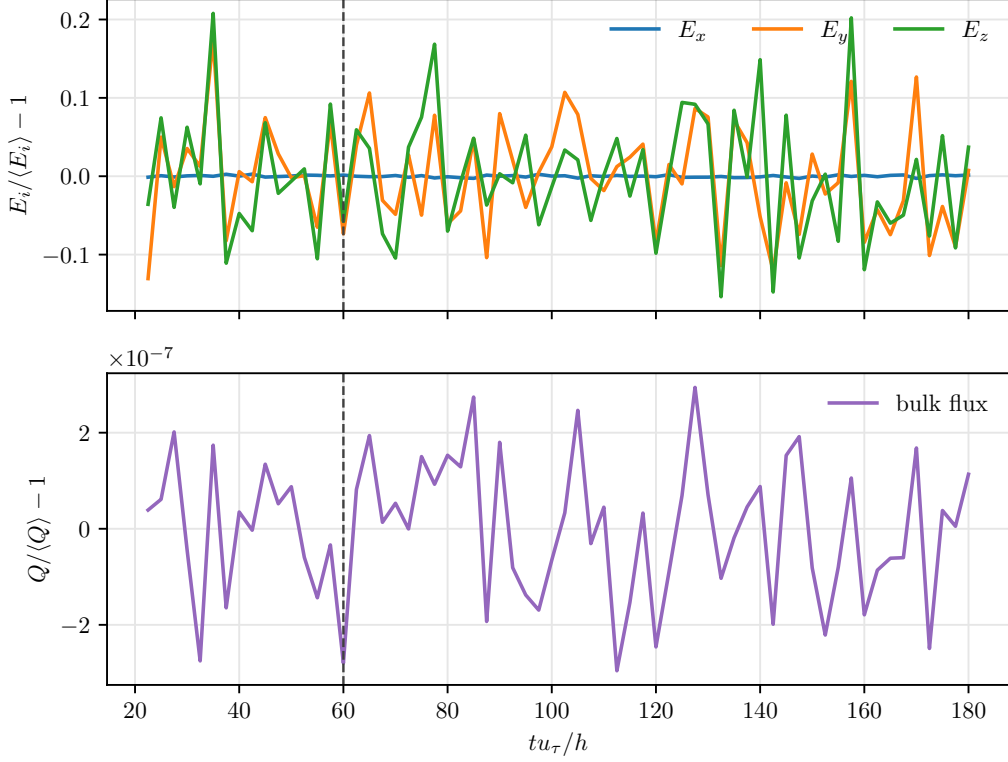


Figure 1: Sampling-stage scalar diagnostics. Upper panel: kinetic-energy components E_x , E_y , and E_z , plotted as relative deviations from their own sampling means. Lower panel: bulk flux Q , plotted as a relative deviation from its sampling mean. The abscissa is tu_τ/h , and the dashed line marks the retained-window start $tu_\tau/h = 60$.

5.2 Instantaneous and mean velocity contours

Figures 2 and 3 separate the instantaneous and mean streamwise-velocity contours. This layout preserves the equal physical aspect ratio of each slice and keeps each colorbar aligned with the height of its corresponding contour. The instantaneous $(x/h, z/h)$ slice fixes a spanwise index and displays u_x/u_τ , while the instantaneous $(y/h, z/h)$ slice fixes a streamwise index and displays the same nondimensional velocity. The mean contours are horizontally homogeneous by construction, since the estimator in Eq. (14) averages over both periodic directions.

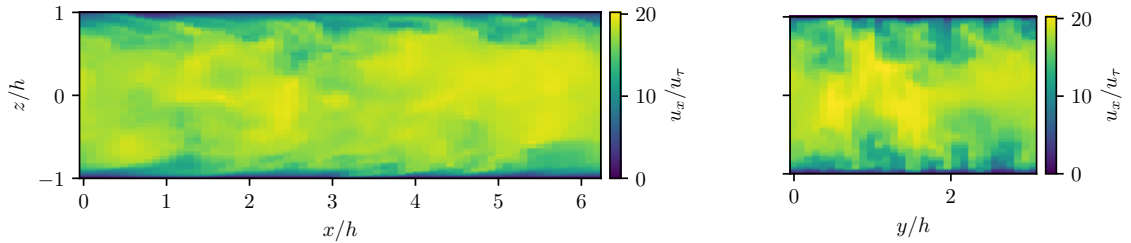


Figure 2: Instantaneous streamwise velocity u_x/u_τ at $tu_\tau/h = 180$. Left panel: streamwise-normal $(x/h, z/h)$ slice at $y/h = 0$. Right panel: spanwise-normal $(y/h, z/h)$ slice at $x/h = 0$.

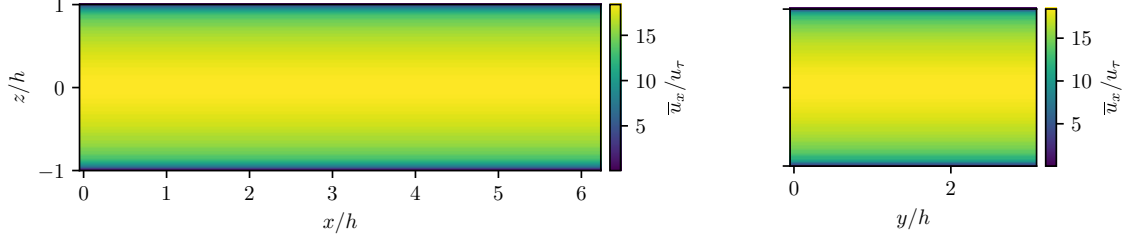


Figure 3: Accepted mean streamwise velocity $\bar{u}_x/u_\tau$ over the $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ target window. Left panel: the wall-normal mean replicated along x/h . Right panel: the same mean replicated along y/h .

5.3 Mean and Reynolds-stress profiles

Figure 4 shows the accepted mean velocity profile. The streamwise component has the expected channel-flow profile, while the spanwise and wall-normal mean components remain small compared with $\bar{u}_x$. The profile is plotted as $\bar{u}_i/u_\tau$ against z/h . Figure 5 shows the six independent components of the Reynolds-stress tensor profile $R_{\alpha\beta}/u_\tau^2$ against z/h . The off-diagonal component R_{xz} carries the dominant shear-stress structure; the other off-diagonal components are small on this scale.

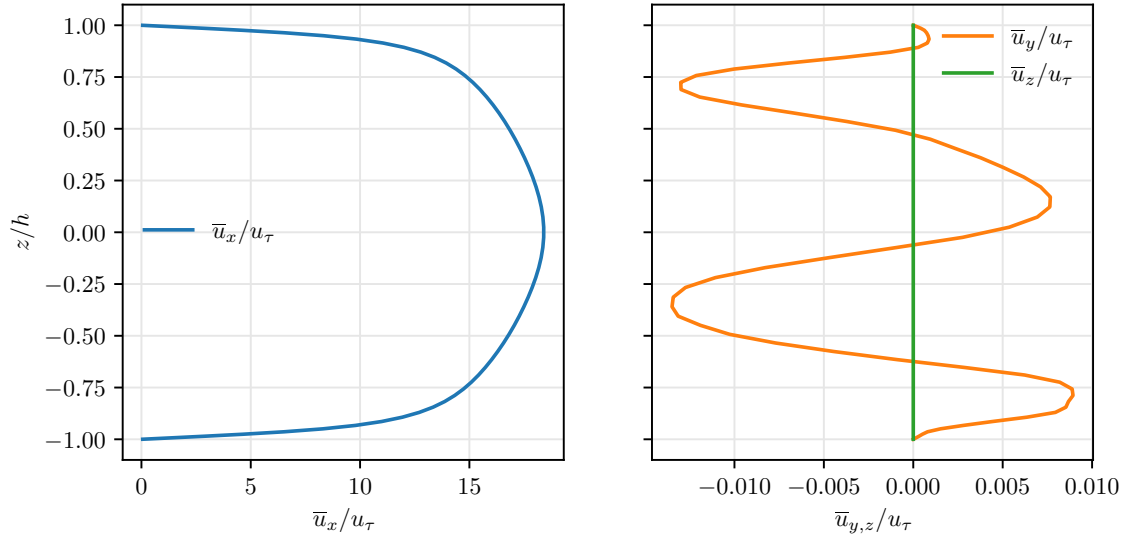


Figure 4: Accepted mean velocity profile computed from the $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ target window. Left panel: streamwise mean $\bar{u}_x/u_\tau$. Right panel: secondary means $\bar{u}_y/u_\tau$ and $\bar{u}_z/u_\tau$.

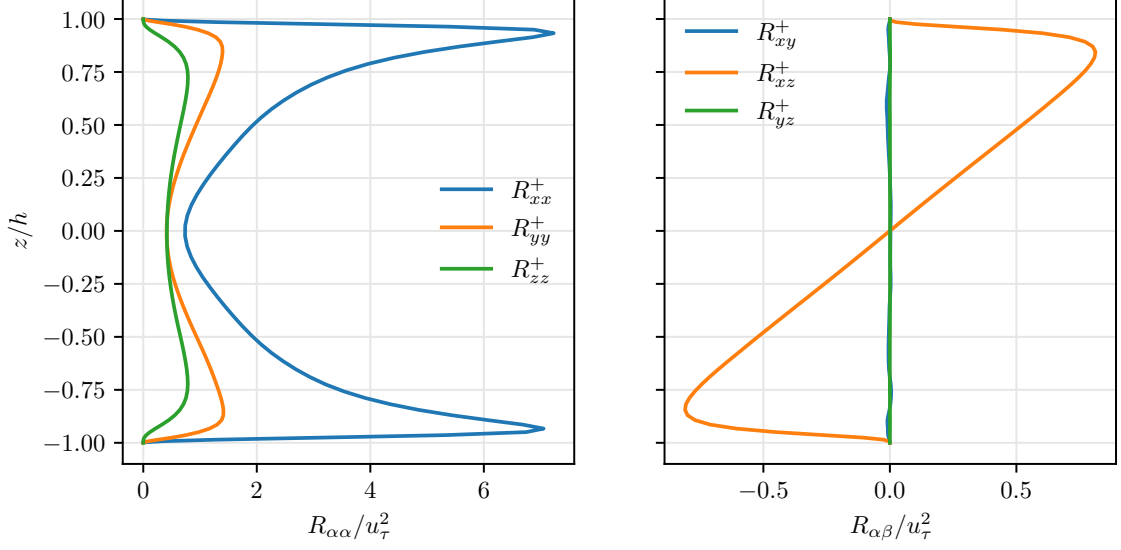


Figure 5: Accepted Reynolds-stress tensor profile computed from the $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ target window. Left panel: diagonal components R_{xx}/u_τ^2 , R_{yy}/u_τ^2 , and R_{zz}/u_τ^2 . Right panel: off-diagonal components R_{xy}/u_τ^2 , R_{xz}/u_τ^2 , and R_{yz}/u_τ^2 .

5.4 Plane-averaged temporal auto-covariances and auto-spectra

The covariance and spectral quantities in the preceding sections are equal-time statistics. For a reproduction run with explicit temporal dynamics, it is also useful to record height-resolved temporal statistics in physical space. The accepted equal-time target uses the $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ production window described above. The temporal figures in this subsection instead use a separate dense continuation restarted from the final $tu_\tau/h = 180$ checkpoint and sampled every 20 DNS steps. This keeps the equal-time target unchanged while improving the temporal lag spacing and frequency range.

Let the dense sample times, measured from the first dense snapshot, be

$$t_n = n\Delta t_s, \quad n = 0, \dots, N_s - 1,$$

where the absolute dense-window range is

$$180.01 \leq t_{\text{abs}}u_\tau/h \leq 300,$$

$N_s = 12000$, and

$$\Delta t_s u_\tau/h = 0.01.$$

The sample spacing Δt_s is the snapshot spacing, not the DNS solver step. For a velocity component $i \in \{x, y, z\}$, define

$$u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) = u_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) - \bar{u}_i^{\text{dense}}(z_m),$$

where $\bar{u}_i^{\text{dense}}(z_m)$ is recomputed from the dense continuation samples. This dense temporal mean is used only for the temporal diagnostics; the target mean profile in Eq. (14) remains the accepted $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ estimator. For an integer lag $s \geq 0$, let

$$\tau_s = s\Delta t_s.$$

The plane-averaged positive-lag auto-covariance at height z_m is estimated by

$$R_{ii}(\tau_s; z_m) = \frac{1}{(N_s - s)N_x N_y} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-s-1} \sum_{j=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{N_y-1} u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_{n+s}) u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n). \quad (48)$$

This is the direct finite-sample approximation of

$$\mathbb{E} \left[u'_i(t + \tau, x, y, z_m) u'_i(t, x, y, z_m) \right],$$

with the expectation replaced by an average over admissible time origins and over the statistically homogeneous x - y plane. The factor $(N_s - s)^{-1}$ appears because only $N_s - s$ pairs are available at lag s , and the dimensionless correlation is

$$\rho_{ii}(\tau_s; z_m) = \frac{R_{ii}(\tau_s; z_m)}{R_{ii}(0; z_m)}. \quad (49)$$

Equation (49) is dimensionless and is plotted against $\tau_s u_\tau / h$.

The corresponding auto-spectrum is computed by a temporal Fourier transform at each fixed (x_j, y_ℓ, z_m) , followed by the same horizontal-plane average. The angular frequencies associated with the N_s -point temporal FFT are

$$\omega_r = 2\pi \text{fftfreq}(N_s, \Delta t_s)_r. \quad (50)$$

For the dense continuation,

$$\Delta\omega^* = \frac{2\pi}{N_s \Delta t_s} \frac{h}{u_\tau} = 0.0523598775599,$$

and the plotted positive branch extends to

$$\omega_{\max}^* = 314.106905482,$$

with Nyquist magnitude $\pi/\Delta t_s \simeq 314.159265359$. Let w_n be an optional temporal window and define the corresponding frequency-indexed Fourier coefficient by

$$\tilde{u}_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m; \omega_r) = \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} w_n u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n) \exp\left(-2\pi i \frac{rn}{N_s}\right), \quad r = 0, \dots, N_s - 1. \quad (51)$$

With the unnormalized discrete Fourier transform in Eq. (51), the two-sided plane-averaged periodogram is

$$S_{ii}(\omega_r; z_m) = \frac{\Delta t_s}{N_x N_y \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} w_n^2} \sum_{j=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{N_y-1} |\tilde{u}_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m; \omega_r)|^2. \quad (52)$$

The dense auto-spectrum figure uses a Hann window. The formula records the normalization for a general window because smoothing is useful for this finite temporal record.

The normalization in Eq. (52) is chosen to be consistent with the two-sided angular-frequency convention. To see this, first consider $w_n = 1$, for which $\sum_n w_n^2 = N_s$. The angular-frequency spacing is

$$\Delta\omega = \frac{2\pi}{N_s \Delta t_s}.$$

Parseval's identity for the unnormalized transform gives

$$\sum_{r=0}^{N_s-1} |\tilde{u}_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m; \omega_r)|^2 = N_s \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} |u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n)|^2.$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{1}{2\pi} \sum_{r=0}^{N_s-1} S_{ii}(\omega_r; z_m) \Delta\omega &= \frac{1}{N_s \Delta t_s} \sum_{r=0}^{N_s-1} \frac{\Delta t_s}{N_s N_x N_y} \sum_{j,\ell} |\tilde{u}_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m; \omega_r)|^2 \\
&= \frac{1}{N_s^2 N_x N_y} \sum_{j,\ell} N_s \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} |u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n)|^2 \\
&= \frac{1}{N_s N_x N_y} \sum_{n,j,\ell} |u'_i(x_j, y_\ell, z_m, t_n)|^2 = R_{ii}(0; z_m). \tag{53}
\end{aligned}$$

Thus, for a rectangular window, the discrete sum of the two-sided periodogram recovers the zero-lag plane-averaged variance. For a nontrivial window such as the Hann window used below, the same calculation recovers the corresponding window-energy-weighted zero-lag estimate. For Figure 7, the dimensional spectrum is normalized by its own discrete two-sided spectral area and then nondimensionalized as

$$S_{ii}^*(\omega_r; z_m) = \frac{S_{ii}(\omega_r; z_m) u_\tau}{h R_{ii}^S(0; z_m)}, \quad \omega_r^* = \frac{\omega_r h}{u_\tau}.$$

Here $R_{ii}^S(0; z_m)$ denotes the zero-lag variance implied by the discrete spectral area. This scaling is dimensionless because $[S_{ii}/R_{ii}^S(0; z_m)] = [t]$, and it gives the normalized two-sided area identity

$$\frac{1}{2\pi} \sum_{r=0}^{N_s-1} S_{ii}^*(\omega_r; z_m) \Delta\omega^* = 1, \quad \Delta\omega^* = \Delta\omega h / u_\tau.$$

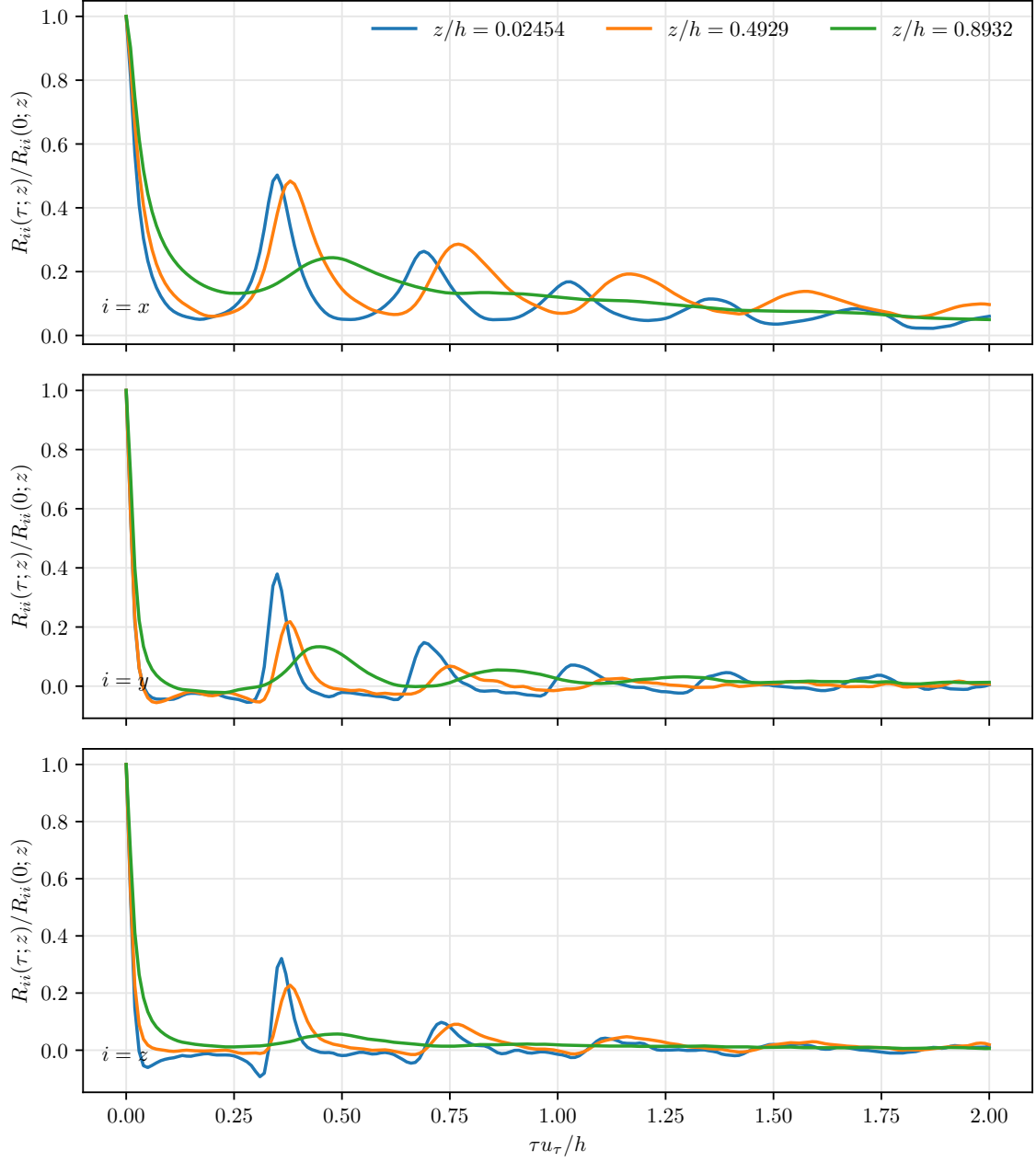


Figure 6: Plane-averaged temporal auto-correlation $R_{ii}(\tau; z)/R_{ii}(0; z)$ from the dense temporal continuation. The three panels correspond to $i = x$, $i = y$, and $i = z$, as indicated inside each panel. Curves show one nonsymmetric half-channel set of wall-normal levels, namely the nearest saved Chebyshev-Gauss levels to $z/h = 0, 0.5, 0.9$. The abscissa is the nondimensional lag $\tau u_\tau/h$, sampled at increments of 0.01.

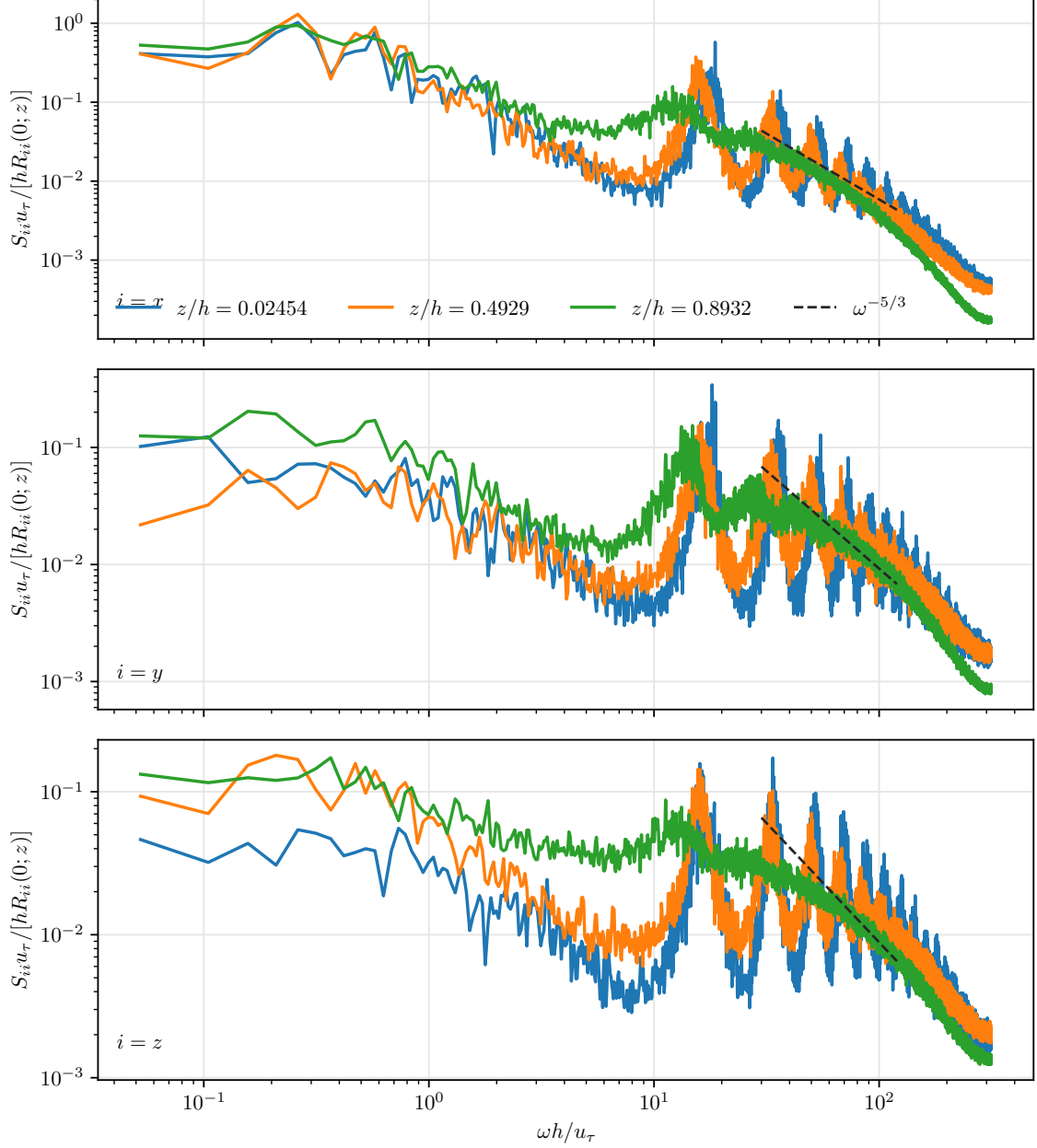


Figure 7: Plane-averaged temporal auto-spectrum computed from the dense temporal continuation using a Hann window. The plotted quantity is the variance-normalized spectrum $S_{ii}(\omega; z)u_\tau/[hR_{ii}^S(0; z)]$ against $\omega h/u_\tau$, using the positive branch of the two-sided angular-frequency periodogram. With this normalization, the two-sided spectral area equals unity for each component and wall-normal level. The three panels correspond to $i = x$, $i = y$, and $i = z$, as indicated inside each panel. Curves show one nonsymmetric half-channel set of wall-normal levels, namely the nearest saved Chebyshev-Gauss levels to $z/h = 0, 0.5, 0.9$. The dashed line gives a $\omega^{-5/3}$ reference slope.

The auto-correlation in Figure 6 shows a clear separation between the streamwise component and the two secondary components. The streamwise fluctuations retain a positive correlation over the entire plotted range $0 \leq \tau u_\tau/h \leq 2$, with the outer half-channel level remaining more correlated than the near-center level after the first few tenths of a turnover time. This behavior is consistent with long streamwise structures in a channel flow and with the dominance of R_{xx} in Figure 5. In contrast, the spanwise and wall-normal components decorrelate rapidly:

after $\tau u_\tau/h \approx 0.1\text{--}0.2$, now resolved by roughly 10–20 dense sample intervals, their correlations fluctuate around zero with only finite-sample oscillations. The one-sided wall-normal selection is used only to avoid duplicating approximately symmetric information. The dense continuation starts from the accepted production final state and is used here for temporal resolution, not as a replacement for the equal-time target.

The log-log spectra in Figure 7 give the same information in the frequency domain after removing the trivial variance amplitude at each height. The streamwise spectra retain relatively more low-frequency content than the spanwise and wall-normal spectra, particularly near the outer half-channel level. The spanwise and wall-normal spectra have shorter-correlation signatures, with comparatively flatter high-frequency floors once normalized by $R_{ii}^S(0; z)$. Relative to the original $\Delta t_s u_\tau/h = 0.1$ production snapshots, the dense continuation extends the plotted positive branch by approximately one decade, to $\omega h/u_\tau \simeq 314$, and refines the lag spacing by the same factor. The dashed $\omega^{-5/3}$ segment is included only as a log-log slope reference over $\omega h/u_\tau = 30\text{--}120$; the finite temporal record and single-record periodogram should not be interpreted as an inertial-range fit. By construction, the variance-normalized two-sided spectral area is one for every plotted component and wall-normal level.

5.5 Target layout and constraint audit

The accepted target contains the following key shapes:

```
mean_profile :          (64, 3),
reynolds_stress_profile : (64, 3, 3),
modal/u_hat :          (1201, 64, 32, 192),
modal/B0_DNS :         (64, 32, 192, 192),
lag_covariance/lag_0 :  (64, 32, 192, 192),
lag_covariance/lag_1 :  (64, 32, 192, 192).
```

The target file size is

11181644712 bytes.

The Chebyshev-quadrature constraint file is

`MKM_constraints_N64_64_32_cheb_quadrature_spectral.h5`.

Its rank audit gives one rank-68 mode and 2047 rank-70 modes:

$$\#\{\text{rank} = 68\} = 1, \quad \#\{\text{rank} = 70\} = 2047.$$

The final audit confirms that the target grid matches both the saved velocity grid and the saved Chebyshev-quadrature constraint grid:

`z_grid_match_velocity = true,      z_grid_match_constraint = true.`

The global residual of the sampled modal covariance under the saved constraint was

$$\frac{\|\tilde{G}\hat{\mathbf{q}}\|}{\|\hat{\mathbf{q}}\|} \approx 5.32 \times 10^{-14},$$

with divergence and boundary contributions

$$5.32 \times 10^{-14} \quad \text{and} \quad 4.16 \times 10^{-16},$$

respectively. These values are near machine precision for the present postprocessing and confirm consistency between the accepted target covariance and the solver-native Chebyshev/quadrature constraint.

6 Admissible projection of the sampled covariance

The preceding audit checks the sampled modal coefficients directly. In this section we also construct the covariance that would be obtained by explicitly projecting the sampled equal-time covariance onto the discrete admissible subspace. This is the covariance denoted by $B_{\text{adm,DNS}}(\kappa_p, \lambda_q)$. The calculation provides an independent end-to-end check that the stored covariance, the saved constraint recipe, and the sampled Reynolds-stress profiles are mutually consistent.

6.1 Notation for one horizontal mode

Fix one horizontal Fourier mode (κ_p, λ_q) , and let

$$d = 3N_z.$$

The stored equal-time DNS covariance for this mode is

$$B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} = \frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)^* \in \mathbb{C}^{d \times d},$$

with the same level-major component ordering as in Eq. (18). The row-orthonormal constraint matrix for the same mode is

$$\tilde{G}_{pq} \in \mathbb{C}^{r_{pq} \times d}, \quad \tilde{G}_{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* = I_{r_{pq}}, \quad (54)$$

where r_{pq} is the numerical rank of $G_{\text{raw}}(\kappa_p, \lambda_q)$. The admissible modal subspace is

$$\mathcal{A}_{pq} = \left\{ v \in \mathbb{C}^d : \tilde{G}_{pq} v = 0 \right\}.$$

6.2 Derivation of the orthogonal projector

Because the rows of $\tilde{G}_{pq}$ are orthonormal, the matrix

$$\tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq}$$

is the orthogonal projector onto the row space of $\tilde{G}_{pq}$. Indeed, for any vector $v \in \mathbb{C}^d$, the row-space component is obtained by first taking row coordinates $\tilde{G}_{pq} v$, and then mapping those coordinates back into the physical modal-vector space with $\tilde{G}_{pq}^*$. The complementary projector is therefore

$$P_{pq} = I_d - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq}. \quad (55)$$

This matrix is Hermitian, since

$$P_{pq}^* = I_d - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} = P_{pq}.$$

It is also idempotent:

$$\begin{aligned} P_{pq}^2 &= \left(I_d - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} \right) \left(I_d - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} \right) \\ &= I_d - 2\tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} + \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \left(\tilde{G}_{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \right) \tilde{G}_{pq} \\ &= I_d - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} = P_{pq}, \end{aligned} \quad (56)$$

where Eq. (54) was used in the penultimate line. Finally,

$$\tilde{G}_{pq} P_{pq} = \tilde{G}_{pq} - \left(\tilde{G}_{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \right) \tilde{G}_{pq} = 0,$$

so the range of P_{pq} is contained in $\mathcal{A}_{pq}$. If $v \in \mathcal{A}_{pq}$, then $\tilde{G}_{pq} v = 0$, and $P_{pq} v = v$. Thus Eq. (55) is exactly the orthogonal projector onto the admissible subspace.

6.3 Projected covariance

Let $\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}$ denote a zero-mean random modal vector with covariance $B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}$. Its admissible projection is

$$\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}^{\text{adm}} = P_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}.$$

Taking the covariance of this projected vector gives

$$\begin{aligned} B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} &= \mathbb{E} \left[\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}^{\text{adm}} \left(\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}^{\text{adm}} \right)^* \right] \\ &= \mathbb{E} \left[P_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}^* P_{pq}^* \right] \\ &= P_{pq} \mathbb{E} \left[\hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}^* \right] P_{pq}^* \\ &= P_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} P_{pq}^*, \end{aligned} \quad (57)$$

because $P_{pq}^* = P_{pq}$. Equation (57) is the covariance used by a generator that enforces the discrete incompressibility and no-slip constraints exactly at the modal-covariance level.

6.4 Exact equality for constrained DNS samples

The near-zero difference between $B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}$ and $B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq}$ is not an independent empirical coincidence. It follows algebraically from using the same discrete constraint in the DNS target and in the projection. Suppose that each sampled modal coefficient satisfies the saved constraint exactly,

$$\tilde{G}_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) = 0, \quad n = 0, \dots, N_s - 1. \quad (58)$$

Then every sample belongs to the admissible subspace $\mathcal{A}_{pq}$. Since P_{pq} is the identity on this subspace,

$$P_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) = \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n). \quad (59)$$

Applying Eq. (59) to the finite-sample covariance estimator gives

$$\begin{aligned} P_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} P_{pq} &= P_{pq} \left[\frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)^* \right] P_{pq} \\ &= \frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} (P_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)) (P_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n))^* \\ &= \frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)^* = B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}. \end{aligned} \quad (60)$$

Combining Eqs. (57) and (60) yields the exact identity

$$B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} = B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \quad (61)$$

for every horizontal mode whose sampled coefficients satisfy Eq. (58).

The same result can be written as a covariance-range statement. From Eq. (58),

$$\tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} = \frac{1}{N_s} \sum_{n=0}^{N_s-1} \left(\tilde{G}_{pq} \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n) \right) \hat{\mathbf{q}}_{pq}(t_n)^* = 0, \quad (62)$$

$$B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* = \left(\tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \right)^* = 0. \quad (63)$$

Substituting Eqs. (62) and (63) into the direct expansion of $P_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} P_{pq}$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} P_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} P_{pq} &= B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} + \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} \\ &= B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}. \end{aligned} \quad (64)$$

Hence the projection cannot change a covariance assembled from exactly constrained samples. Any nonzero $\|B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}\|$ in the production calculation is therefore a finite-precision diagnostic: it measures floating-point roundoff, SVD compression and reconstruction tolerances, and HDF5 read/write arithmetic, not a physical or statistical modification of the target covariance.

The implementation evaluates Eq. (57) from the stored data. If a dense $\tilde{G}_{pq}$ is present in the constraint file, it is read directly. The production constraint file stores seven representative compressed matrices by default; for the remaining modes, the postprocessor reconstructs $\tilde{G}_{pq}$ from the saved arrays D_z , B_∂ , E_x , E_y , E_z , κ_p , and λ_q by applying the same SVD compression derived in Section 4. Thus all ingredients are taken from the target and constraint HDF5 files. The numerical formula used in the script is the expanded form

$$B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} = B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} - \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} + \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq} B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq} \tilde{G}_{pq}^* \tilde{G}_{pq}, \quad (65)$$

followed by explicit Hermitian symmetrization at roundoff level.

6.5 Reynolds stresses reproduced from a modal covariance

The sampled Reynolds-stress profile can also be reconstructed from any modal covariance C^{pq} with the same Fourier normalization as the target file. Let $s(x) = 0$, $s(y) = 1$, and $s(z) = 2$, and define the level-major index

$$\ell(m, \alpha) = 3m + s(\alpha).$$

The inverse horizontal Fourier representation of the fluctuation field is

$$u'_\alpha(x_j, y_\ell, z_m) = \sum_{p=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{q=0}^{N_y-1} \hat{u}_\alpha(z_m; \kappa_p, \lambda_q) \exp[i(\kappa_p x_j + \lambda_q y_\ell)],$$

because the forward transform in Eq. (17) already contains the factor $1/(N_x N_y)$. Multiplying two components and averaging over the horizontal grid gives

$$\langle u'_\alpha u'_\beta \rangle_{xy} = \sum_{p,q} \sum_{p',q'} \hat{u}_\alpha(z_m; \kappa_p, \lambda_q) \hat{u}_\beta(z_m; \kappa_{p'}, \lambda_{q'})^* \left\langle e^{i[(\kappa_p - \kappa_{p'})x + (\lambda_q - \lambda_{q'})y]} \right\rangle_{xy}. \quad (66)$$

The discrete Fourier modes are orthogonal on the sampled periodic grid, so

$$\left\langle e^{i[(\kappa_p - \kappa_{p'})x + (\lambda_q - \lambda_{q'})y]} \right\rangle_{xy} = \delta_{pp'} \delta_{qq'}.$$

Therefore only equal horizontal modes survive, and the Reynolds-stress profile implied by C^{pq} is

$$R_{\alpha\beta}^C(z_m) = \sum_{p=0}^{N_x-1} \sum_{q=0}^{N_y-1} C_{\ell(m,\alpha),\ell(m,\beta)}^{pq}. \quad (67)$$

No additional $N_x N_y$ factor appears in Eq. (67); it has already been fixed by the forward and inverse transform convention. In the comparison below, Eq. (67) is evaluated for both $C^{pq} = B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}$ and $C^{pq} = B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq}$.

6.6 Production computation and comparison

The projected covariance was computed with

`scripts/mkm_dns_target/project_mkm_dns_covariance.py.`

For the production data set, the script wrote

MKM_production_64.64_32_projected_covariance_t60_t180.h5,

which contains $B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq}$, the Reynolds profiles implied by $B_{0,\text{DNS}}$ and $B_{\text{adm,DNS}}$, and modewise projection diagnostics. The run processed all $64 \times 32 = 2048$ horizontal modes. Seven $\tilde{G}_{pq}$ matrices were read directly from saved representative-mode groups, and the remaining 2041 were reconstructed from the saved constraint operators.

Table 2: Projection and Reynolds-stress consistency diagnostics for the accepted $60 \leq tu_\tau/h \leq 180$ production target. Norms are Frobenius norms unless otherwise stated.

Diagnostic	Value
Global $\ B_{\text{adm,DNS}} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}\ /\ B_{0,\text{DNS}}\ $	1.1046×10^{-15}
Maximum modewise $\ B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}\ /\ B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}\ $	5.6548×10^{-15}
Relative trace change $(\text{tr } B_{\text{adm,DNS}} - \text{tr } B_{0,\text{DNS}})/\text{tr } B_{0,\text{DNS}}$	0.0
Total $\text{tr } B_{0,\text{DNS}}$	260.3681545
Maximum projected constraint residual	8.8989×10^{-17}
$\ R^{B_{0,\text{DNS}}} - R^{\text{sample}}\ /\ R^{\text{sample}}\ $	2.9426×10^{-15}
$\ R^{B_{\text{adm,DNS}}} - R^{\text{sample}}\ /\ R^{\text{sample}}\ $	2.9326×10^{-15}
$\ R^{B_{\text{adm,DNS}}} - R^{B_{0,\text{DNS}}}\ /\ R^{B_{0,\text{DNS}}}\ $	2.0371×10^{-16}
$\max R^{B_{\text{adm,DNS}}} - R^{\text{sample}} $	3.8192×10^{-14}

The values in Table 2 are therefore best interpreted as a finite-precision verification of Eq. (61). The exact-arithmetic prediction is that the explicit projection leaves the production equal-time covariance unchanged. The observed 10^{-15} -level changes are consistent with the direct modal-coefficient audit in Section 5: the sampled velocity coefficients already satisfy the saved Chebyshev/quadrature divergence and no-slip constraints to near machine precision.

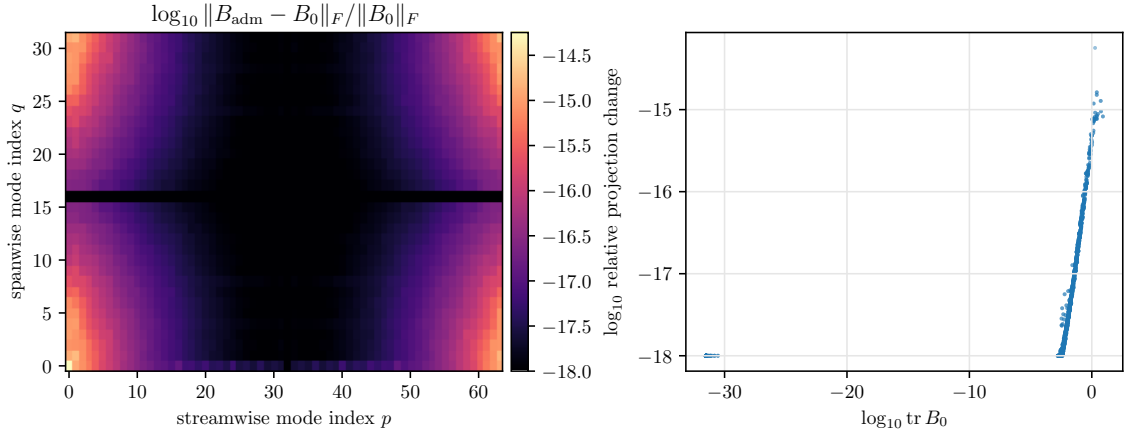


Figure 8: Modewise finite-precision effect of the admissible covariance projection. Left: relative Frobenius-norm change $\|B_{\text{adm,DNS}}^{pq} - B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}\|_F / \|B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}\|_F$. Right: the same relative projection change plotted against modal covariance energy $\text{tr } B_{0,\text{DNS}}^{pq}$.

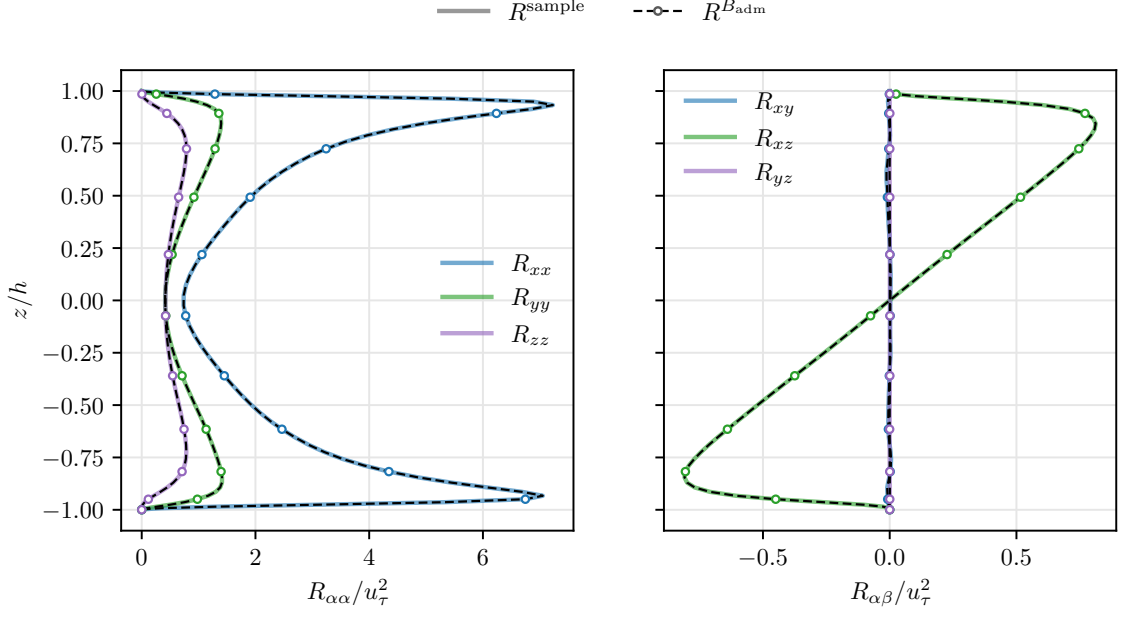


Figure 9: Reynolds-stress profiles from the sampled physical-space estimator and from the projected modal covariance. Solid colored curves show R^{sample} . The projected profiles $R^{B_{\text{adm,DNS}}}$, computed from Eq. (67), are drawn as black dashed curves with open colored markers so that the exact overlap is visible.

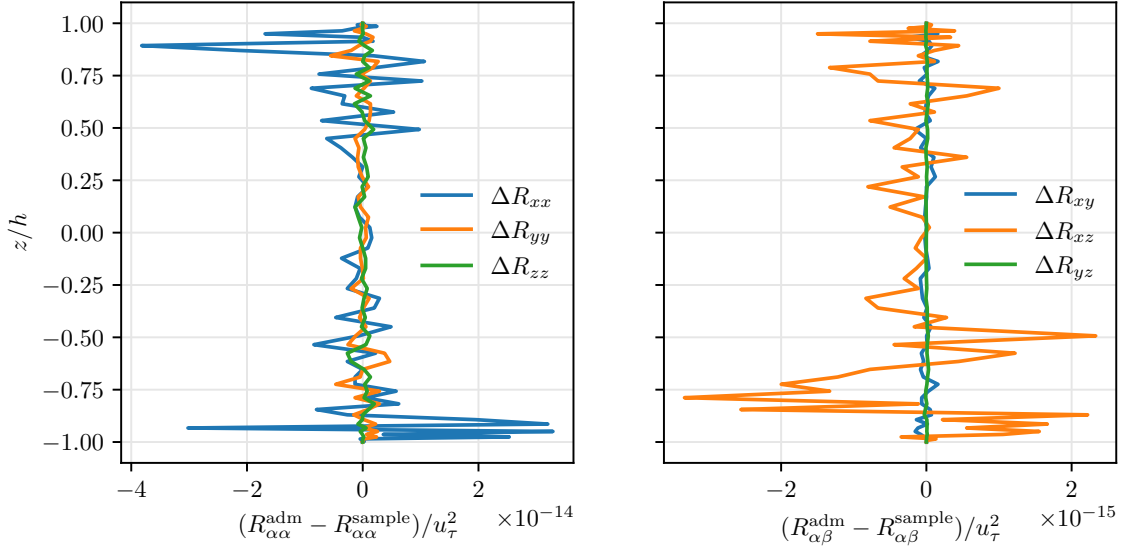


Figure 10: Pointwise differences between the Reynolds-stress profiles implied by $B_{\text{adm,DNS}}$ and those sampled directly in physical space. The horizontal axes are nondimensionalized by u_τ^2 . The errors are at roundoff level relative to the profile magnitudes.

7 Reproducibility remarks

The production handoff file

HANDOFF_production_mkm_64_64_32.md

records the exact server paths, commands, convergence reports, and audit files. For future runs on this mesh, the validated production setting is 16 MPI ranks. A different MPI decomposition should be re-tested together with the FFT pencil decomposition constraints. If a stricter scalar-energy stationarity criterion is required, the sampling record should be extended beyond $tu_\tau/h = 180$, and the retained-window field and scalar convergence checks should be repeated before regenerating the target covariance.